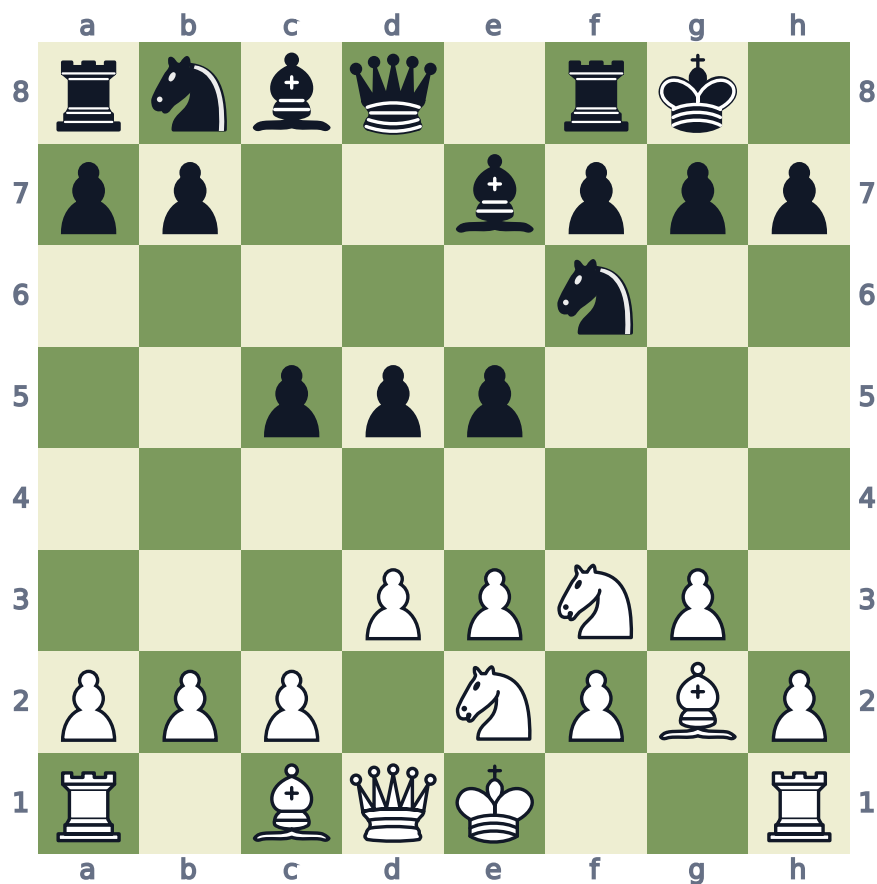


White Hippo Piece Maneuvers, King Safety, and Defense

Knight routes, bishops, queen placement, rook files, prophylaxis, and emergency play



Coordinate the compact White setup, improve its least active piece, and defend accurately when Black attacks before the break is ready.

15 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Coordinate the compact White setup, improve its least active piece, and defend accurately when Black attacks before the break is ready.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 15 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

Nd2 can reach f3, c4, or b3; Ne2 can reach c3, g3, or f4.

PRINCIPLE 2

Bb2 is useful only when its diagonal contains a target or will open soon.

PRINCIPLE 3

The queen belongs behind the chosen break, not on a memorized square.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Castle before the center opens unless a concrete reason says otherwise.

PRINCIPLE 5

A useful waiting move removes one Black option and prepares one White plan.

PRINCIPLE 6

Emergency defense begins with checks, captures, threats, and the opponent's break.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Nd2 to f3 | Choose the knight route from its destination, not the setup diagram. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Nd2 to c4 | A closed center gives time for a knight route with a concrete target. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Ne2 to c3 | Ne2-c3 is useful when f4 is less important than central control. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Ne2 to f4 | Check the e-pawn before Nf4; after e5 the square may be tactically poisoned. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Bb2 after safe preparation | Trace both long diagonals before fianchettoing the second bishop. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Bishop stays on c1 | Do not fianchetto by habit; wait for a useful diagonal. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Queen behind e4 | Clear the queen's path, then place it behind the chosen break. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Queen behind f4 | Qe1 is useful only when f4 is concrete. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 9-15

- | | | |
|-----------|---|---|
| 09 | Rook behind the e-pawn | Put the rook behind the break only after the center confirms the file. |
| 10 | Rook behind the f-pawn | Rook placement should preserve the planned pawn lever. |
| 11 | Castle before opening the center | When central contact is imminent, king safety is development. |
| 12 | Prophylaxis with a3 | A useful waiting move removes a concrete option and prepares a plan. |
| 13 | Prophylaxis with h3 | h3 is useful when it removes a real piece jump. |
| 14 | Emergency defense against e4 | Checks and captures replace the setup checklist when the center advances. |
| 15 | Emergency defense against f5 | When Black attacks early, neutralize the forcing idea and then resume the plan. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Nd2 to f3



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. Nf3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Reroute the d2 knight to f3 when e5 and d4 need more control.

MAIN DANGER

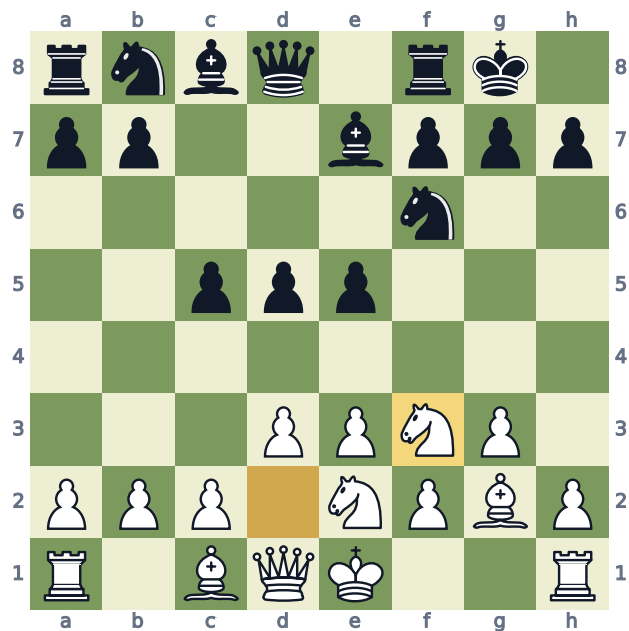
e4 can attack the knight and gain space.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Choose the knight route from its destination, not the setup diagram.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.93 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qc7 b3 2. Nc6 O-O 3. h6 c4 4. Rd8 Nc3 5. d4 exd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Nd2 to f3

**YOUR TASK**

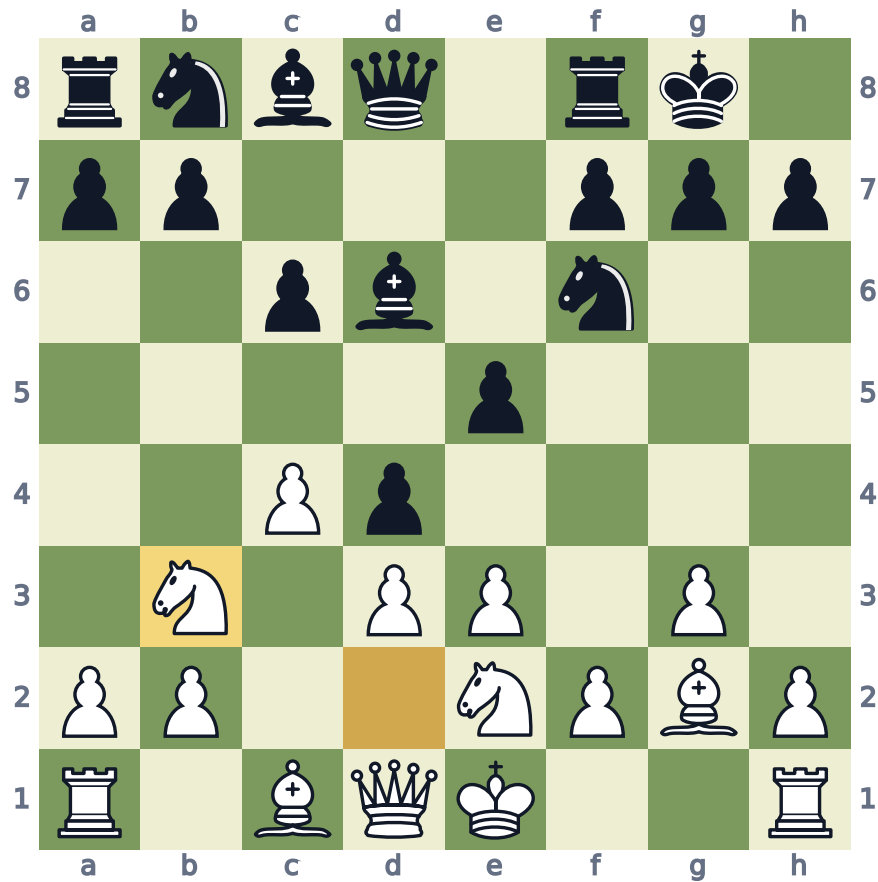
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Nd2 to c4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. c4 d4 8. Nb3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

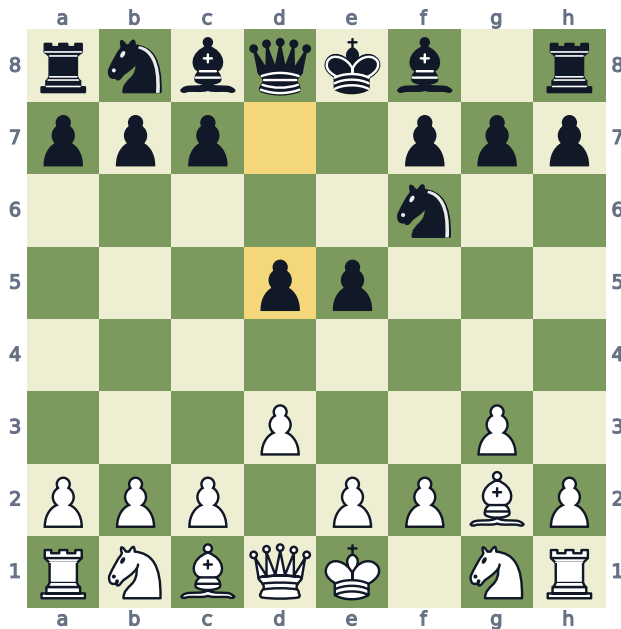
Use b3 as a route toward c5 and d4 after the center closes.

MAIN DANGER

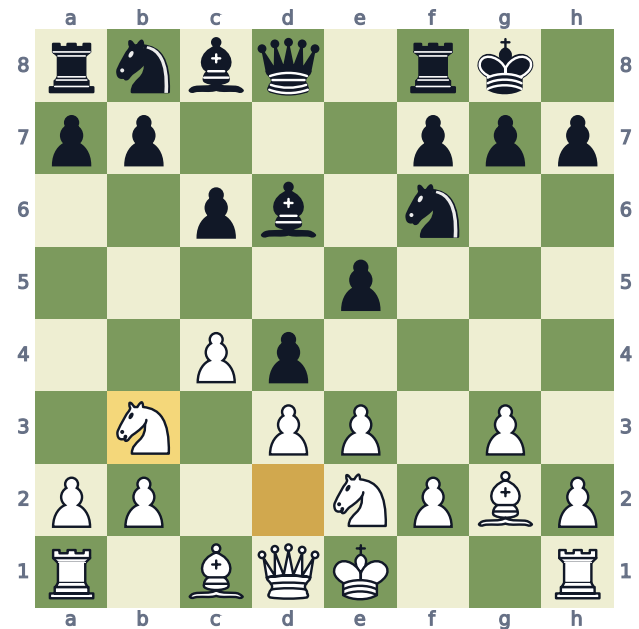
b5 can chase the knight and gain queenside space.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A closed center gives time for a knight route with a concrete target.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

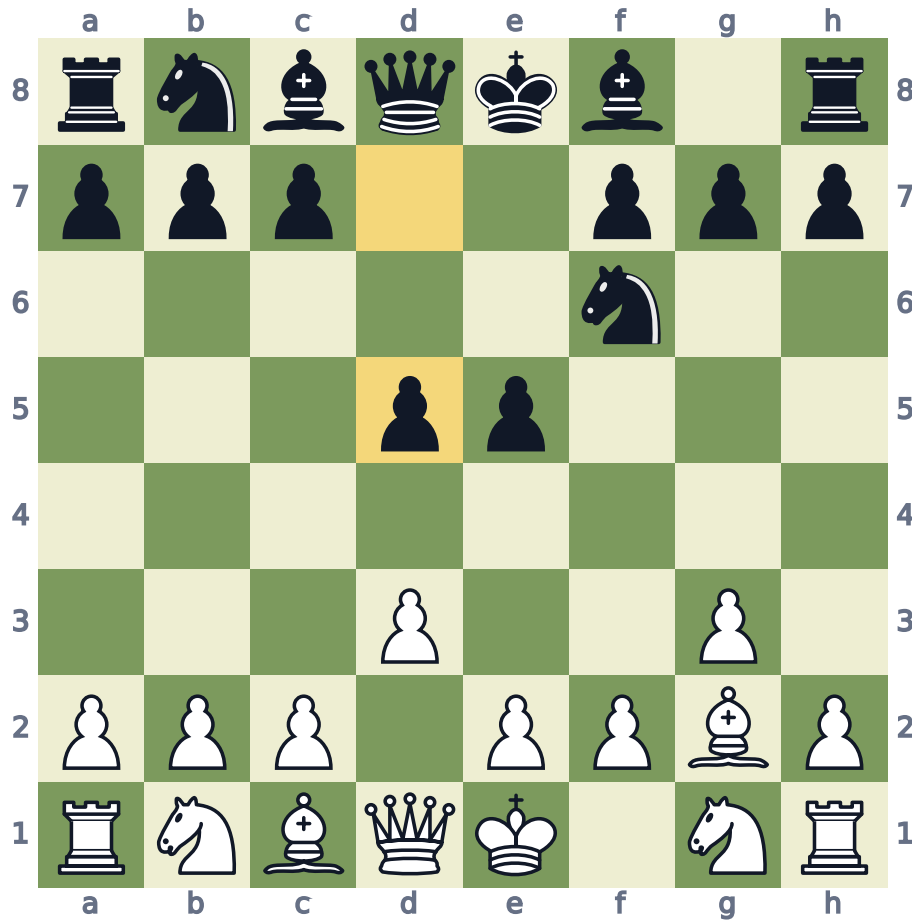
Position estimate: -0.77 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 exd4 2. a4 Nd2 3. exd4 O-O 4. Re8 Nf3 5. c5 Bg5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Nd2 to c4



YOUR TASK

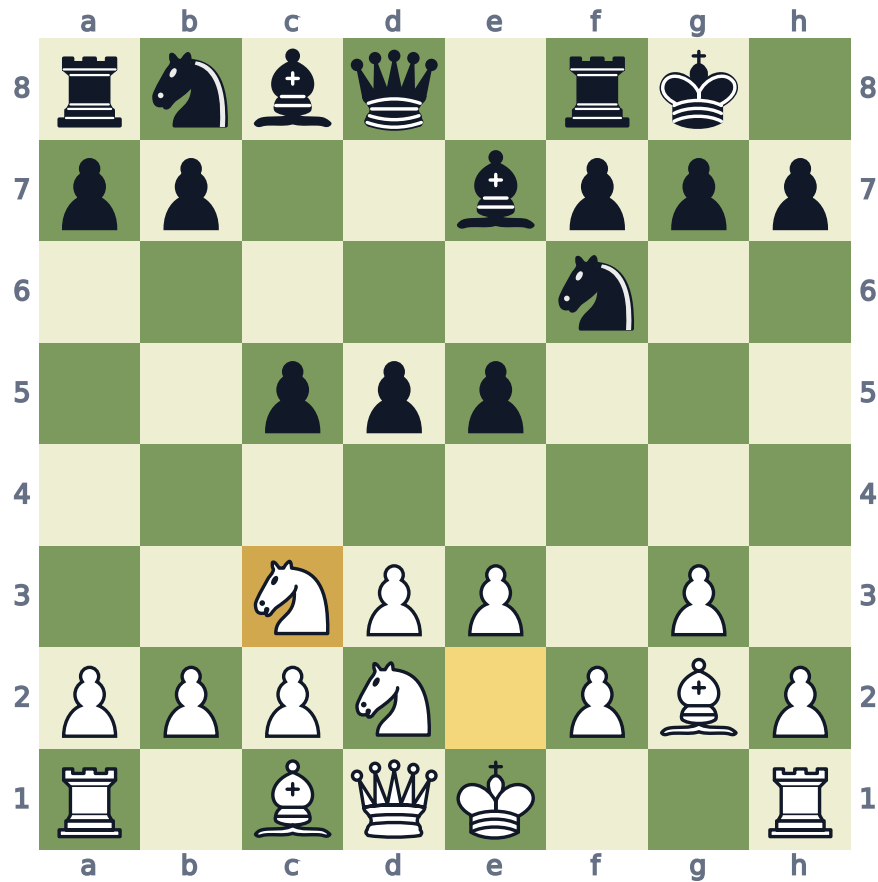
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Ne2 to c3



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. Nc3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Develop toward d5 and e4 when the f-pawn is no longer the main plan.

MAIN DANGER

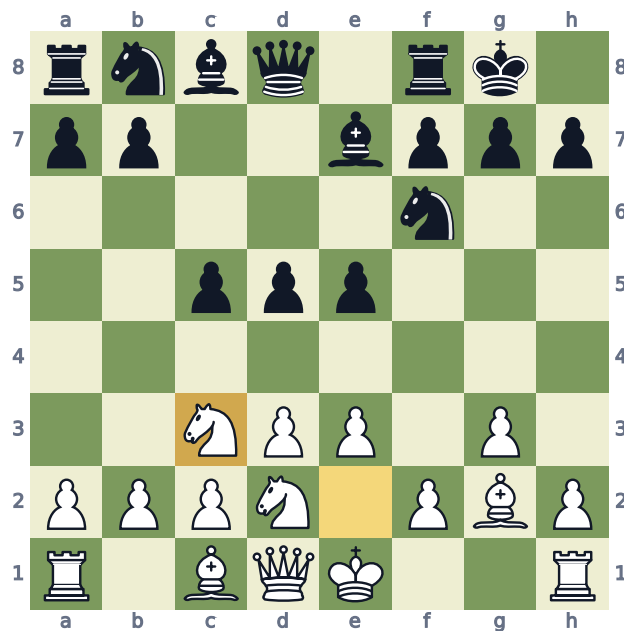
d4 can chase the knight or restrict it.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Ne2-c3 is useful when f4 is less important than central control.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.95 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. Bg4 f3 3. Be6 e4 4. Qd7 f4 5. exf4 gxf4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Ne2 to c3



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Ne2 to f4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 c6 7. Nf4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

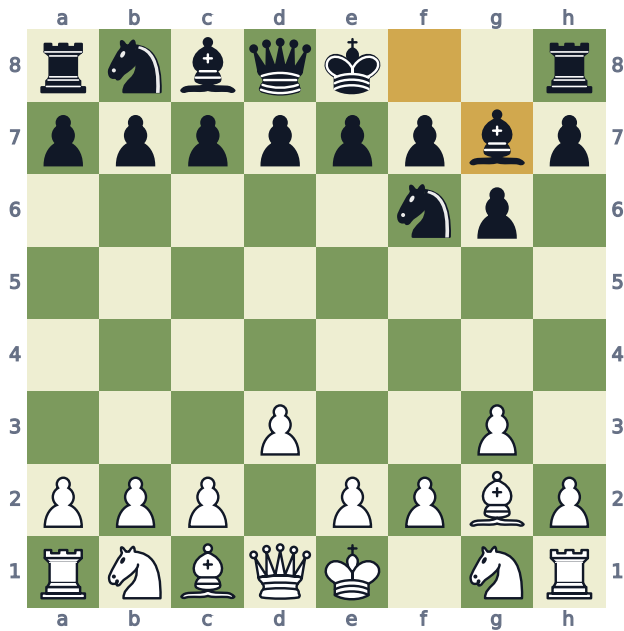
Aim at e6 and d5 while Black has no e5 pawn that can capture the knight.

MAIN DANGER

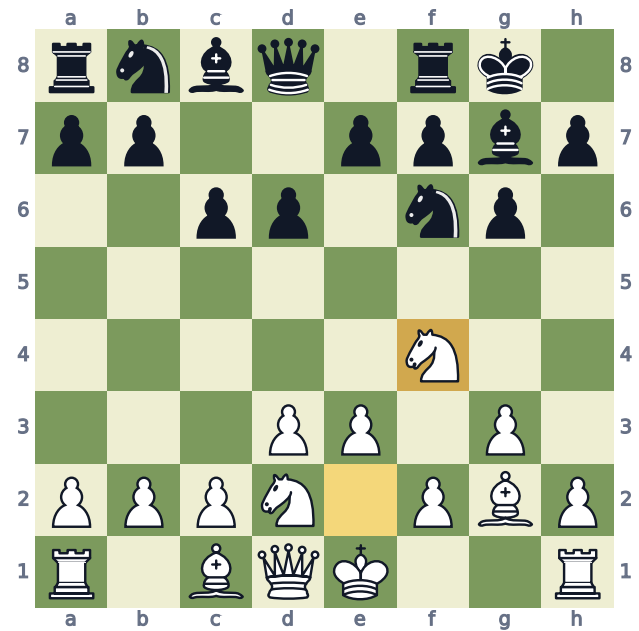
g5 or e5 can challenge the knight later.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Check the e-pawn before Nf4; after e5 the square may be tactically poisoned.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

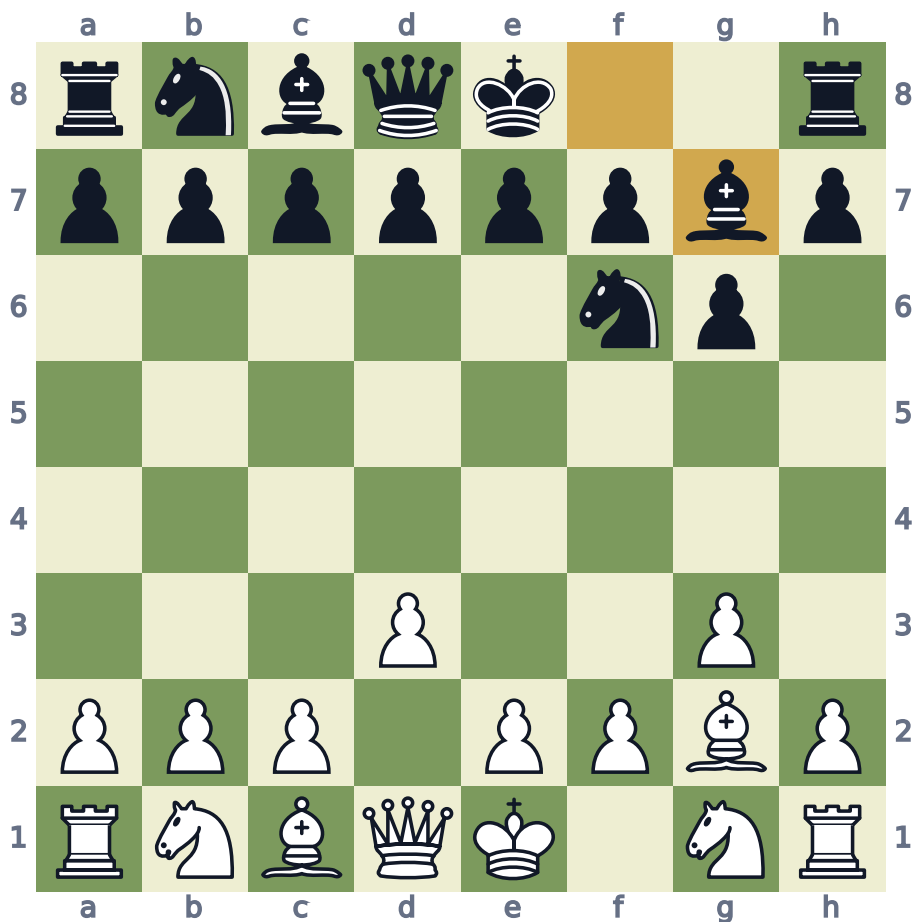
Position estimate: -0.70 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 Ne2 2. d5 O-O 3. Re8 b3 4. a5 Bb2 5. b5 c4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Ne2 to f4



YOUR TASK

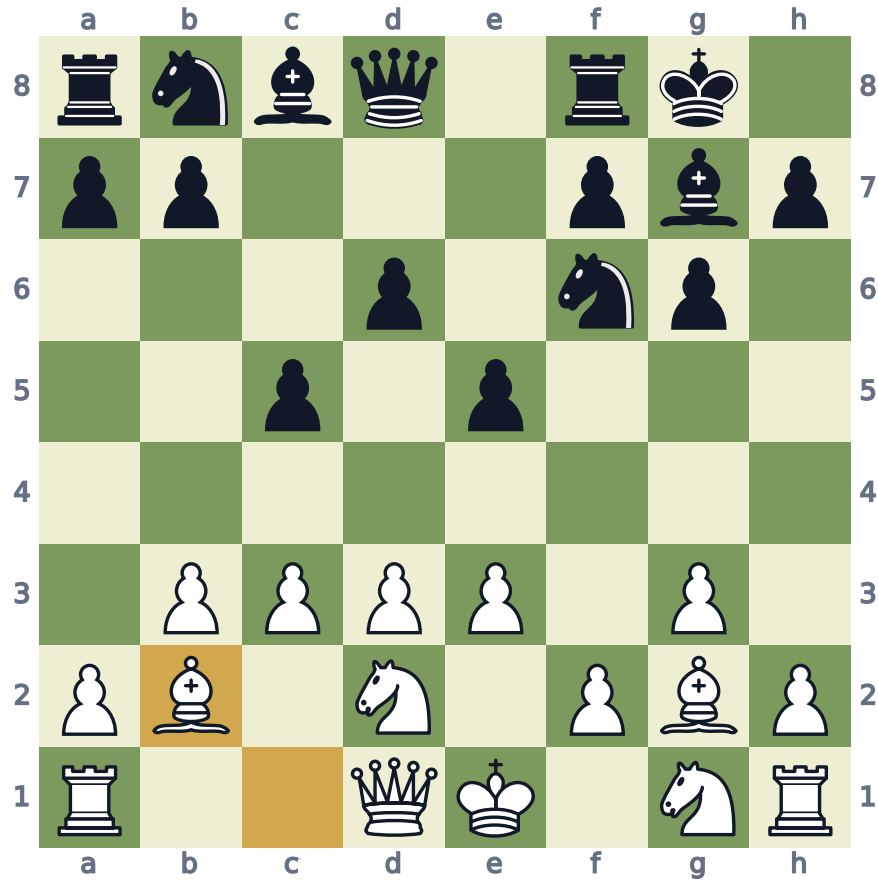
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Bb2 after safe preparation

**COURSE LINE**

1. g3 g6 2. Bg2 Bg7 3. d3 d6 4. Nd2 e5 5. e3 c5 6. c3 Nf6 7. b3 O-O 8. Bb2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

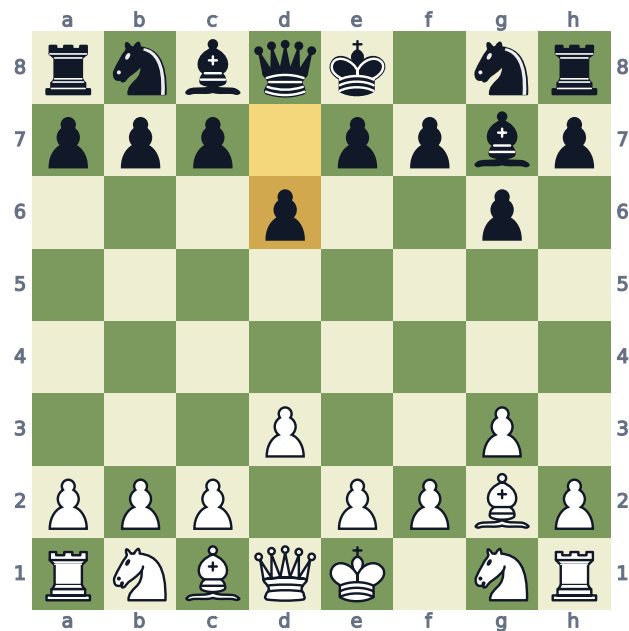
Activate the queen bishop only after c3 closes the a1 diagonal.

MAIN DANGER

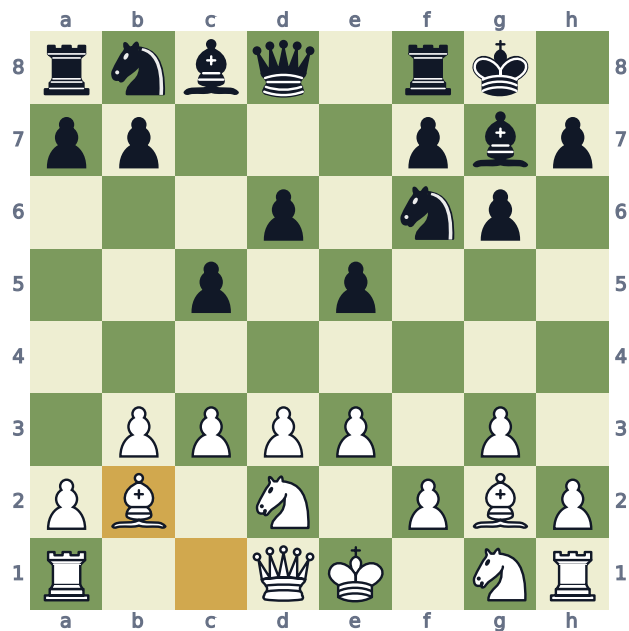
d5 can close the bishop's line immediately.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Trace both long diagonals before fianchettoing the second bishop.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

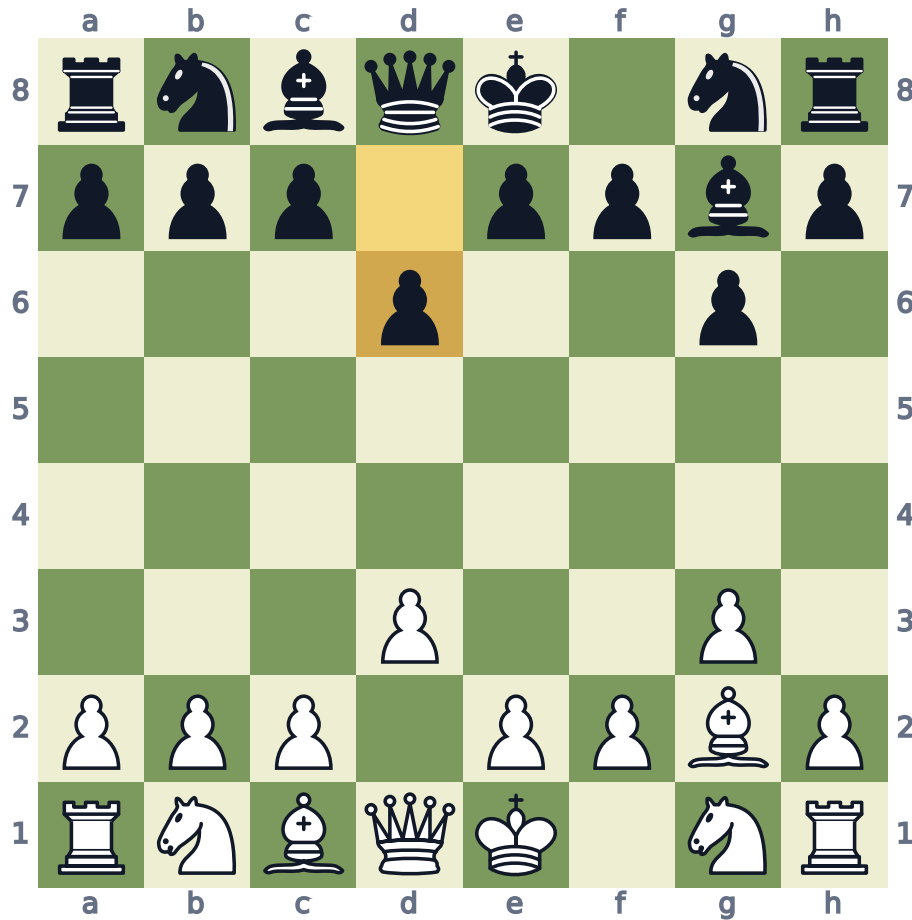
Position estimate: -0.71 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 Ngf3 2. Re8 Qc2 3. Nc6 O-O 4. Be6 Ng5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Bb2 after safe preparation



YOUR TASK

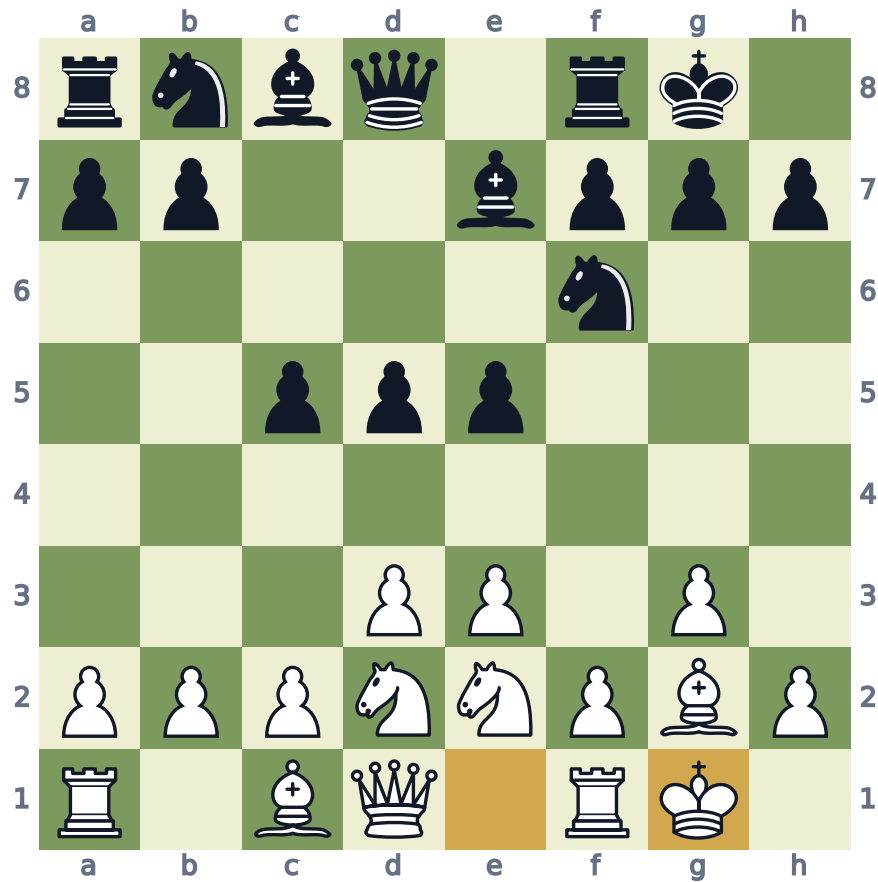
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Bishop stays on c1



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Delay b3 and Bb2 while the center may open and the bishop can use d2 or g5.

MAIN DANGER

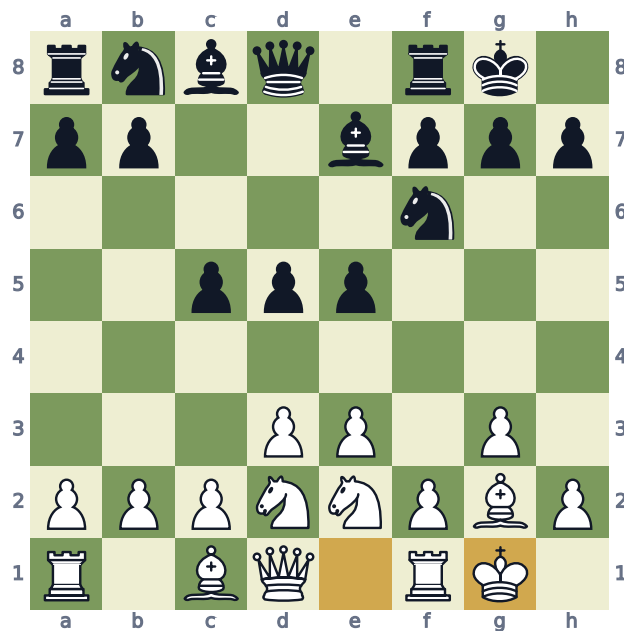
d4 can restrict the bishop if it remains undeveloped too long.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Do not fianchetto by habit; wait for a useful diagonal.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

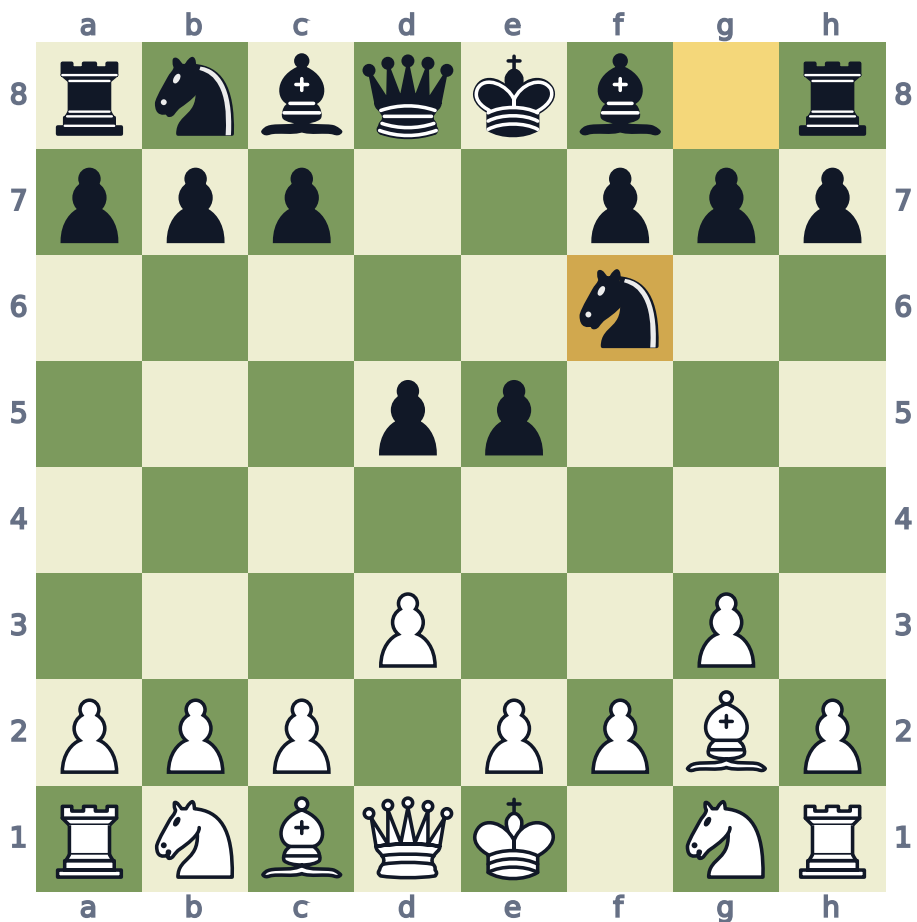
Position estimate: -0.54 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 d4 2. e4 dxc5 3. Bxc5 c4 4. dxc4 Nxc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Bishop stays on c1



YOUR TASK

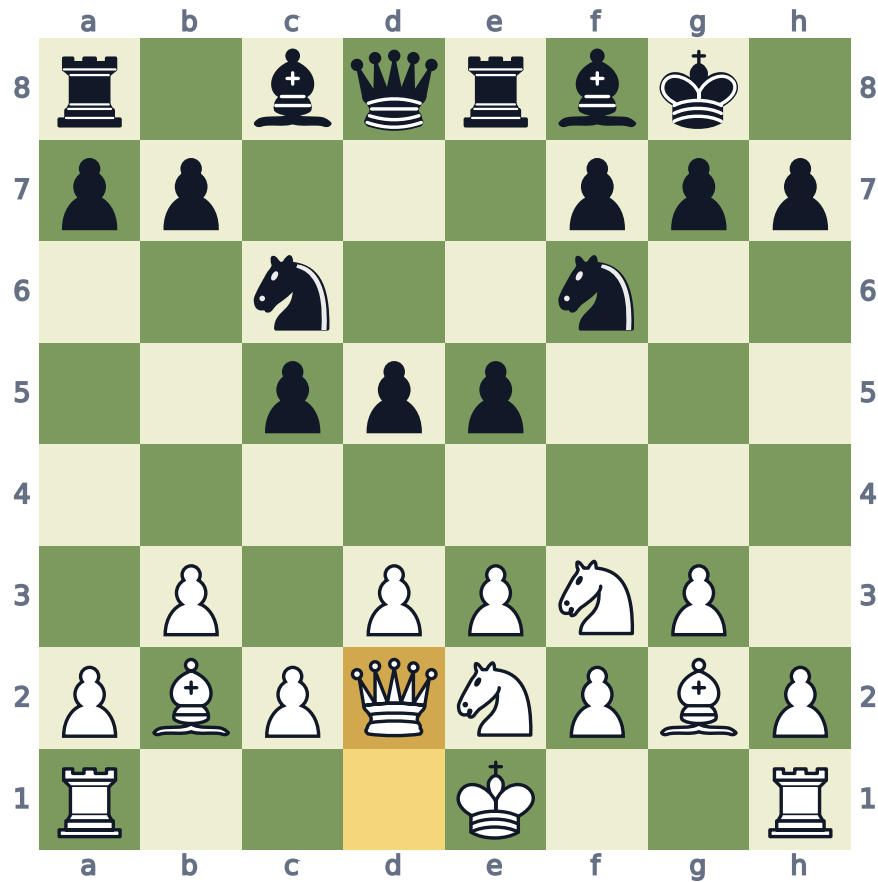
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Queen behind e4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. b3 Nc6 8. Bb2 Re8 9. Nf3 Bf8 10. Qd2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

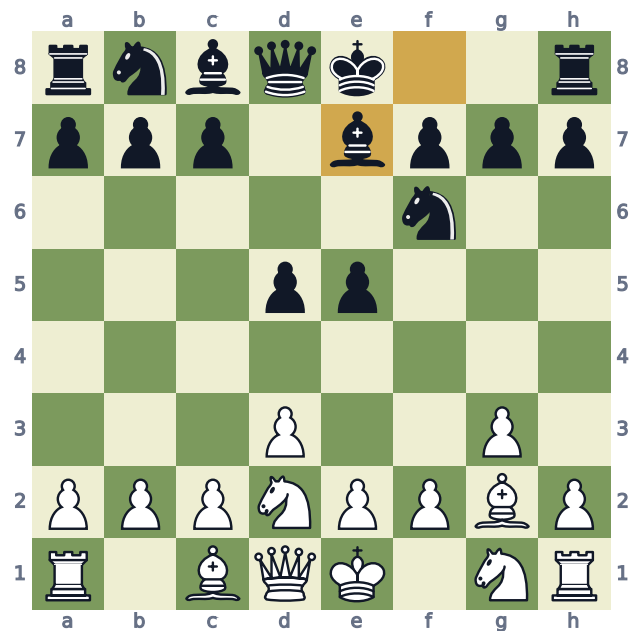
Use Qd2 to connect rooks and support e4 after the knight clears the file.

MAIN DANGER

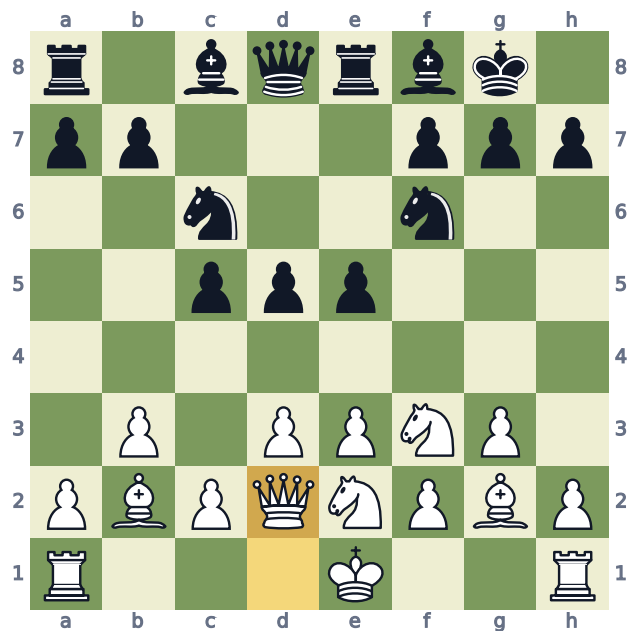
d4 can attack the queen's future route and close Bb2.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Clear the queen's path, then place it behind the chosen break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

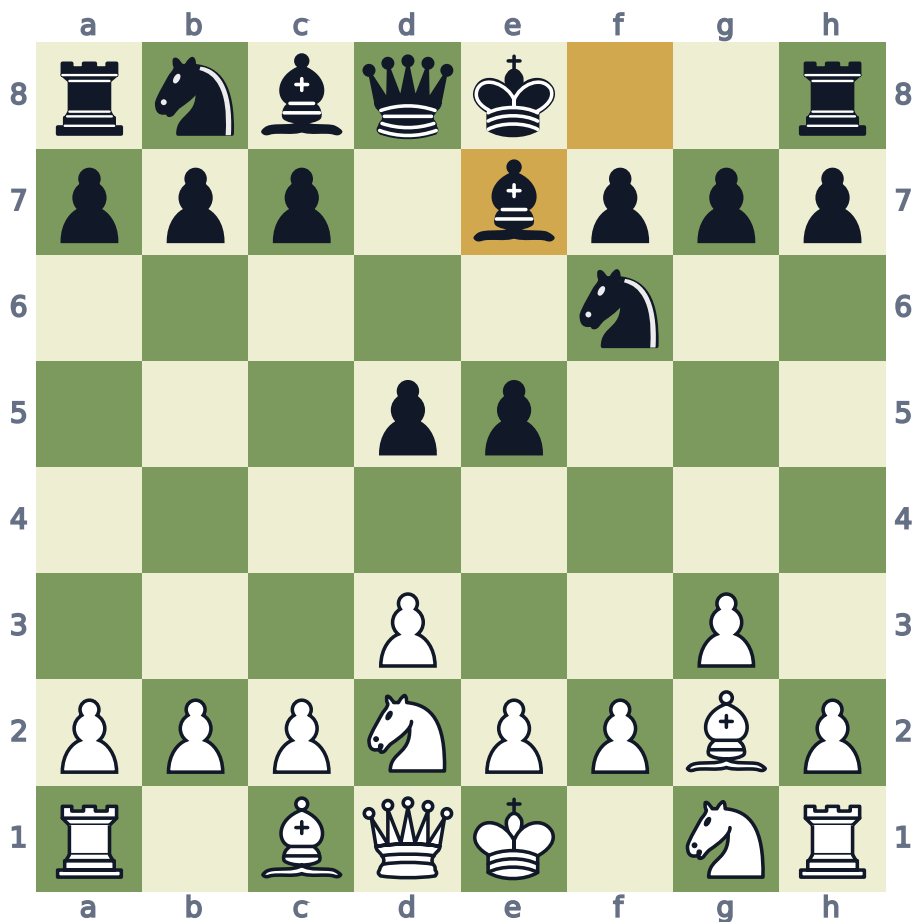
Position estimate: -1.36 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. e4 dxe4 2. Nxe4 Qd1 3. Qa5+ c3 4. d4 O-O 5. Nxc3 Bxc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Queen behind e4



YOUR TASK

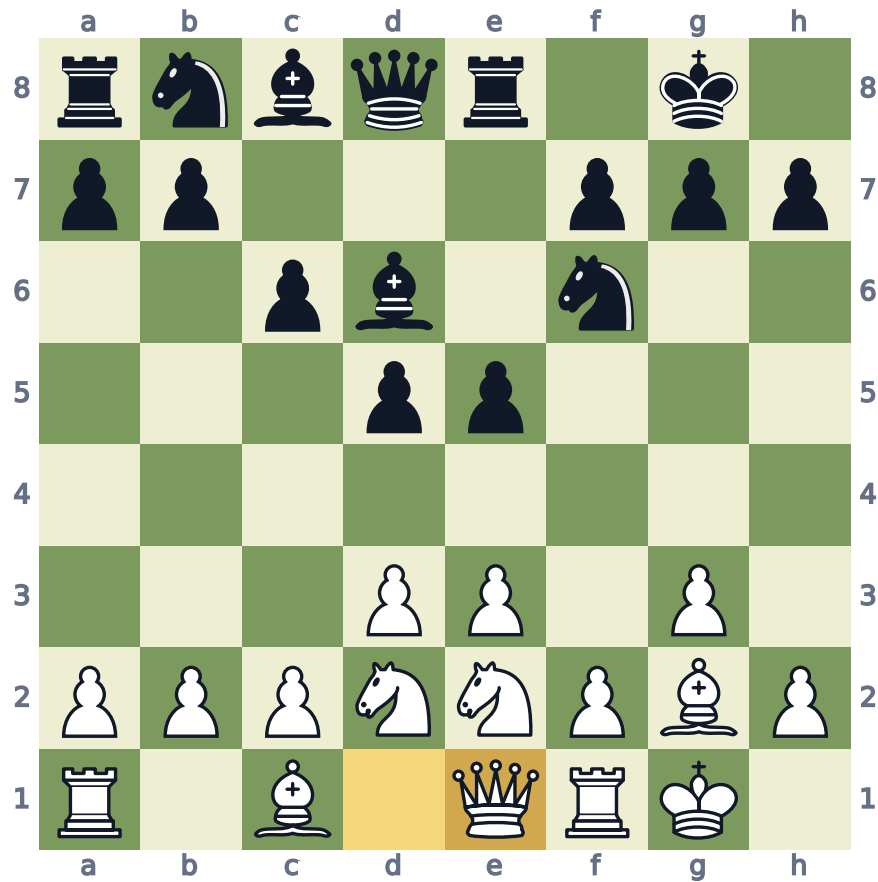
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Queen behind f4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. O-O Re8 8. Qe1

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Support f4 and keep d1 free for a rook.

MAIN DANGER

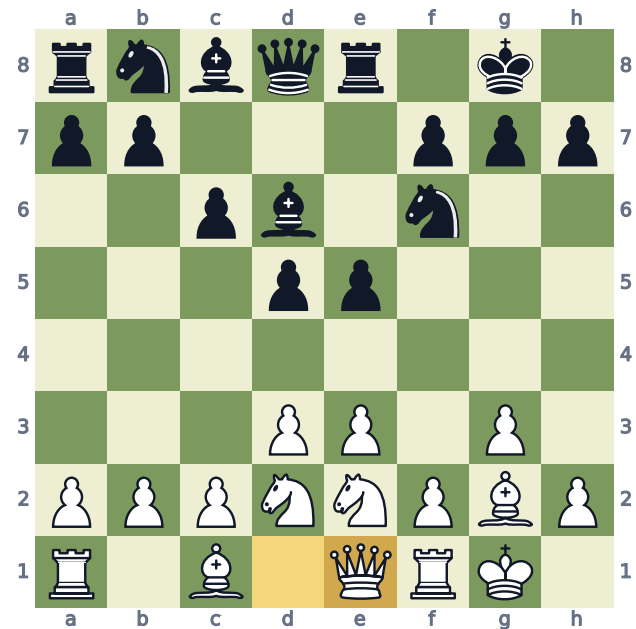
exf4 can open the e-file against the queen.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Qe1 is useful only when f4 is concrete.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.06 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 b3 2. a4 bxa4 3. Rxa4 c4 4. Ra8 a3 5. h6 cxd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Queen behind f4



YOUR TASK

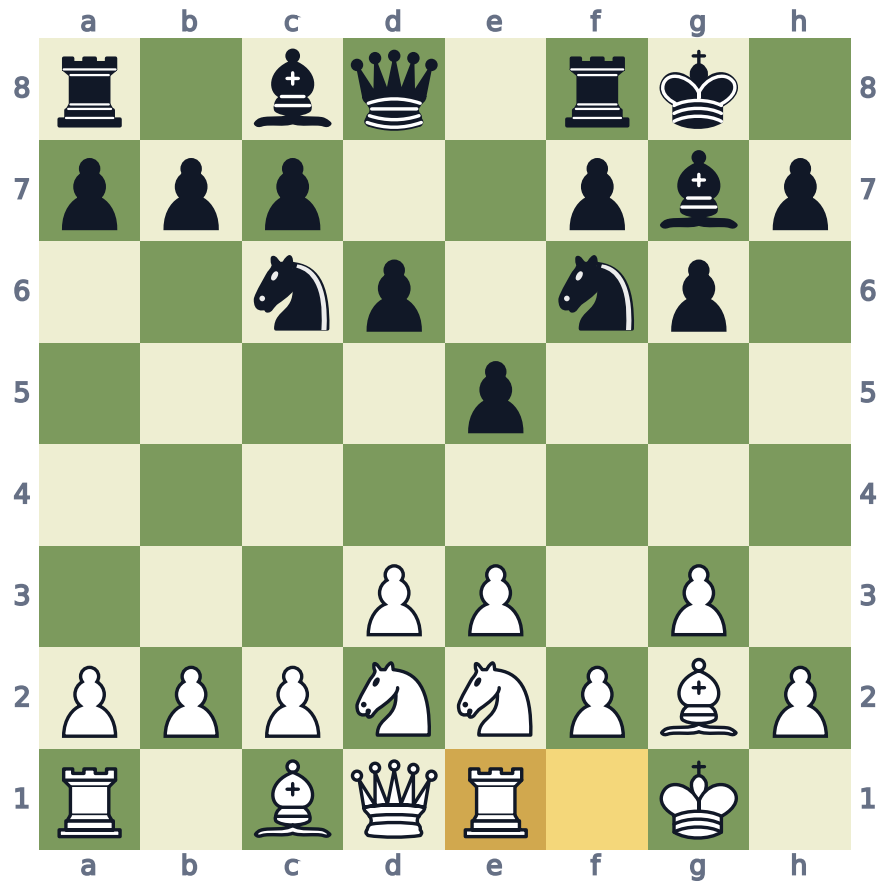
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 09

Rook behind the e-pawn



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

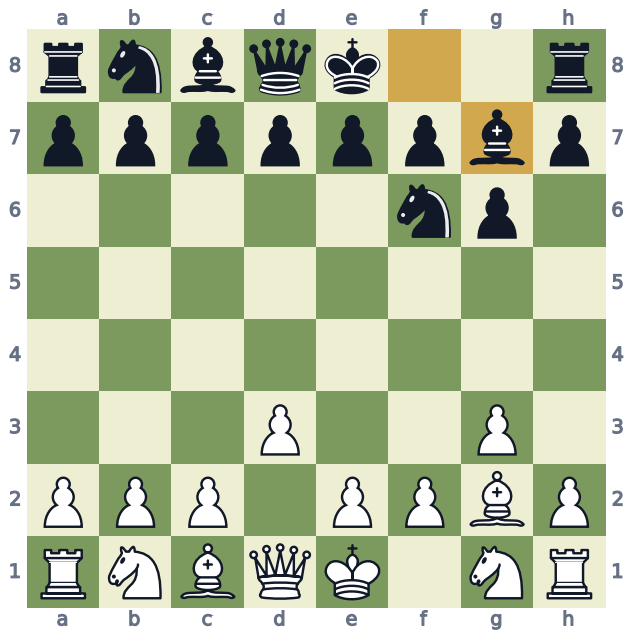
Prepare e4 with the rook already supporting the file likely to open.

MAIN DANGER

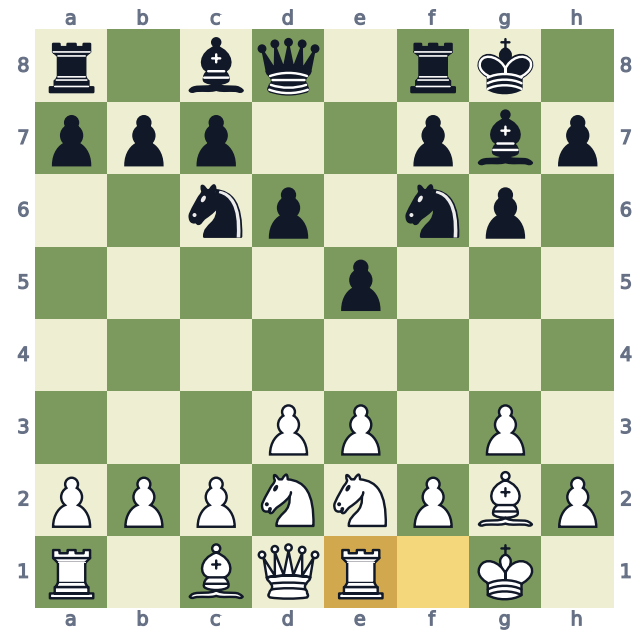
d5 can close the center and make the rook passive.

BRANCH LOGIC 09

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Put the rook behind the break only after the center confirms the file.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

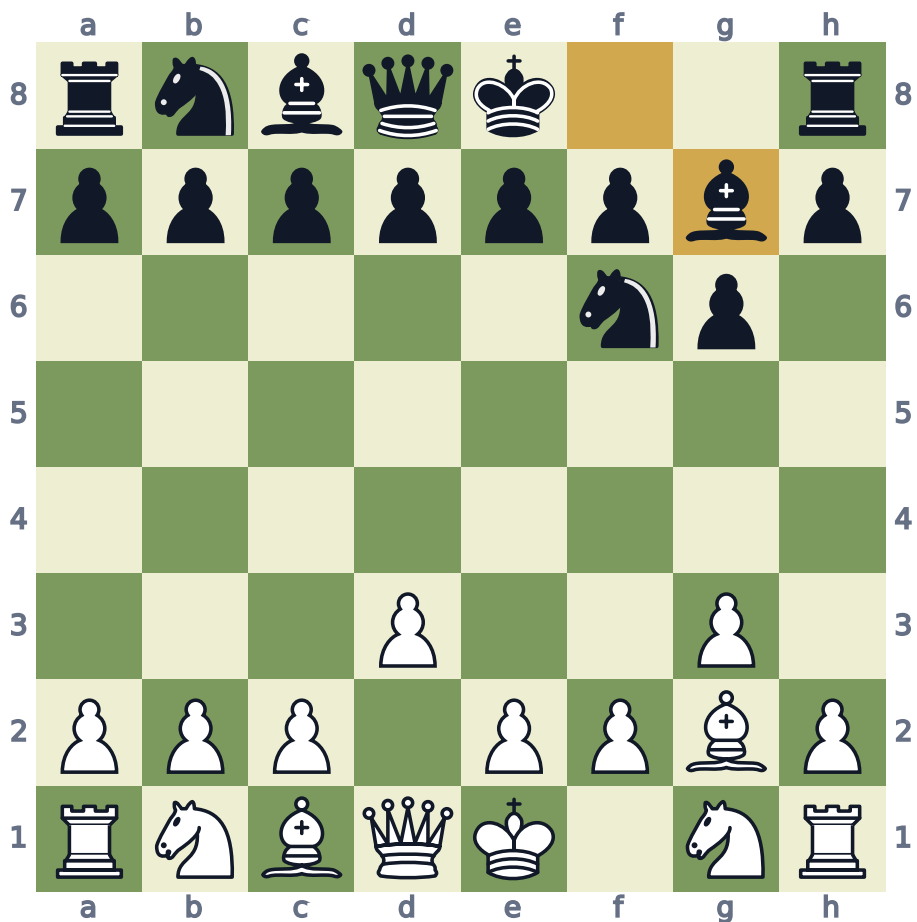
Position estimate: -0.36 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d5 b3 2. Re8 Bb2 3. a5 a3 4. Bf5 e4 5. dxe4 dxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 09

Rook behind the e-pawn



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 10

Rook behind the f-pawn



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. O-O Re8 8. Rb1

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Keep the f-rook ready for f4 while the queenside rook supports b4.

MAIN DANGER

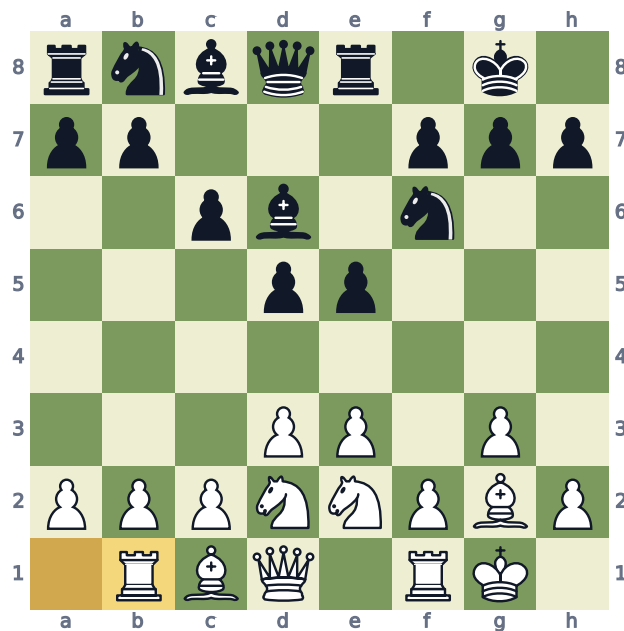
b5 can make the rook a tactical target.

BRANCH LOGIC 10

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Rook placement should preserve the planned pawn lever.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.93 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. a5 b3 2. Na6 h3 3. h6 Bb2 4. Bf5 g4 5. Bg6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 10

Rook behind the f-pawn



YOUR TASK

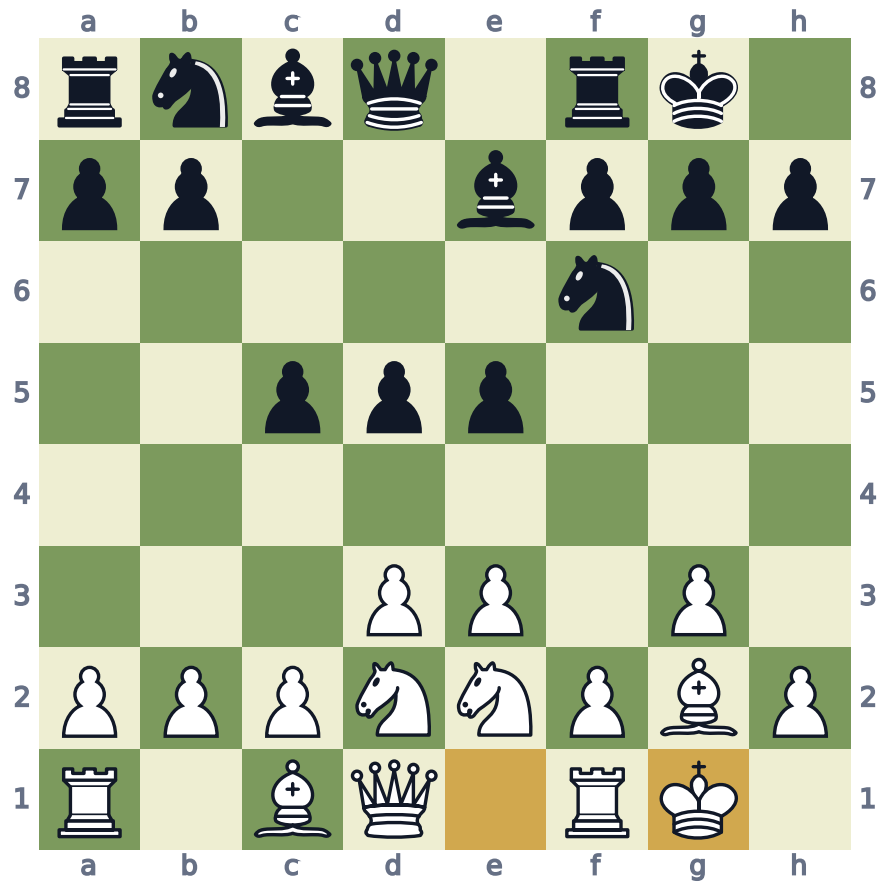
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 11

Castle before opening the center



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

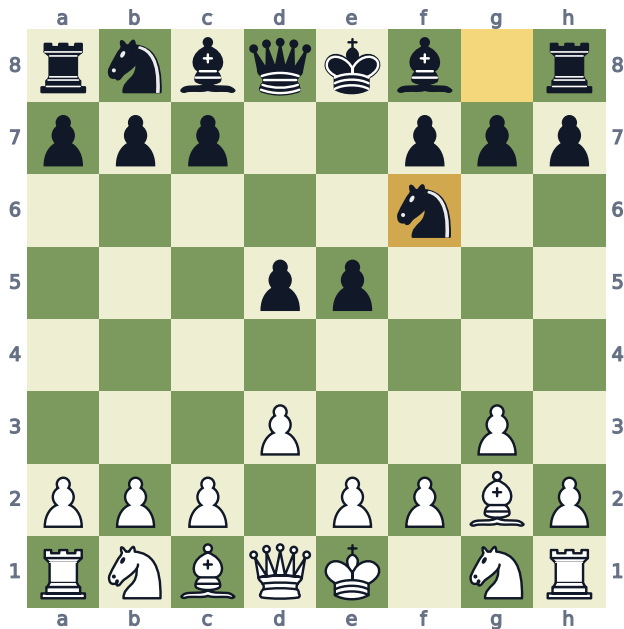
Secure the king before e4, c4, or d4 opens files.

MAIN DANGER

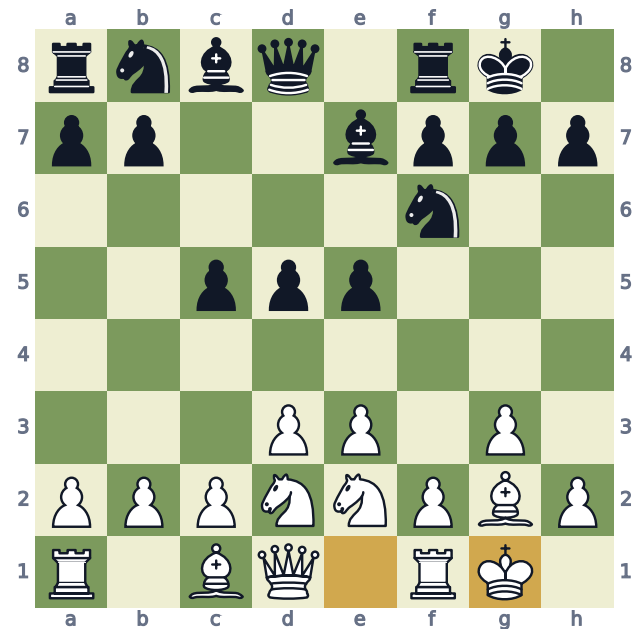
d4 can gain space during the castling tempo.

BRANCH LOGIC 11

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When central contact is imminent, king safety is development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.54 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 d4 2. e4 dxc5 3. Bxc5 c4 4. dxc4 Nxc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 11

Castle before opening the center



YOUR TASK

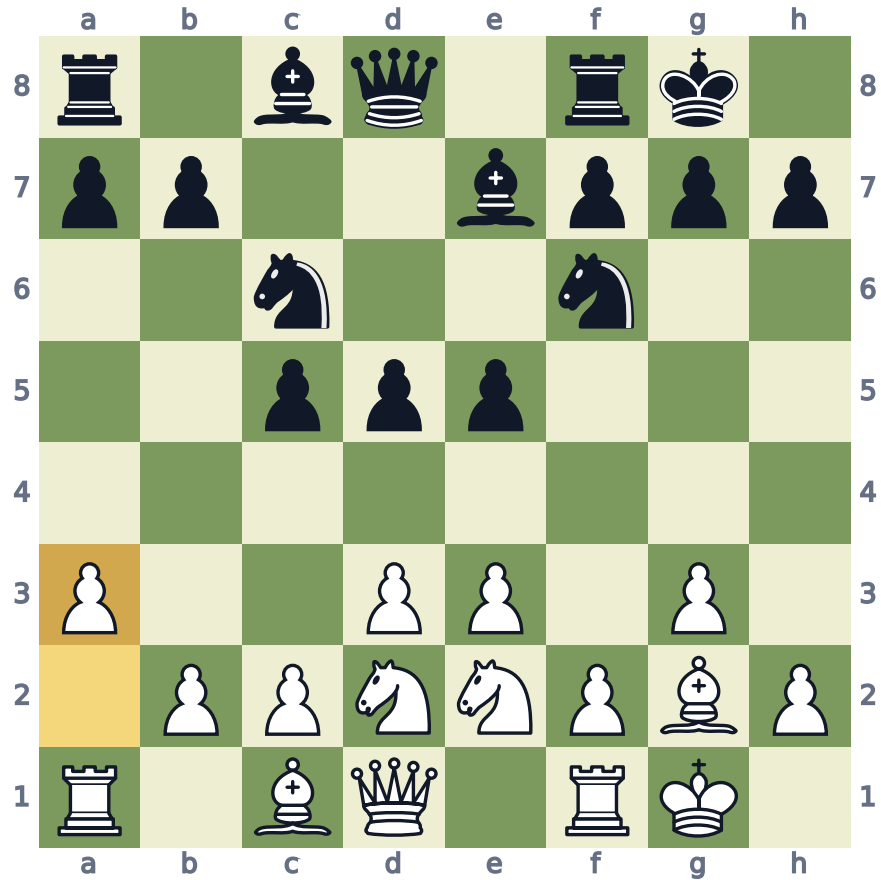
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 12

Prophylaxis with a3



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. a3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Prevent Bb4 ideas and prepare b4 only if the center stays stable.

MAIN DANGER

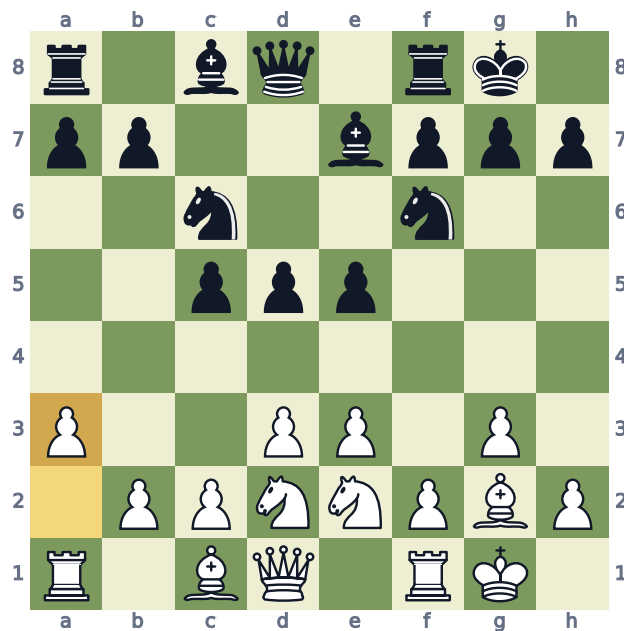
d4 can make a3 look slow.

BRANCH LOGIC 12

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A useful waiting move removes a concrete option and prepares a plan.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.84 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be6 b3 2. Re8 f4 3. Ng4 Nf3 4. e4 dxe4 5. dxe4 Qxd8

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 12

Prophylaxis with a3



YOUR TASK

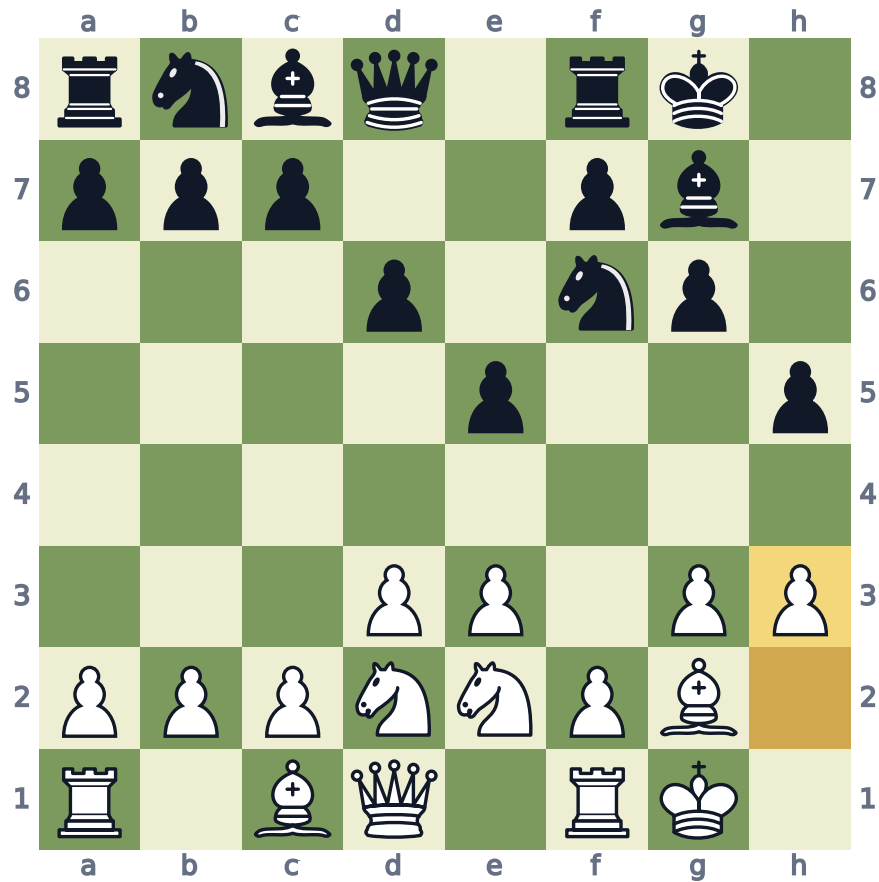
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 13

Prophylaxis with h3



COURSE LINE

1. g3 Nf6 2. Bg2 g6 3. d3 Bg7 4. Nd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Ne2 e5 7. O-O h5 8. h3

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

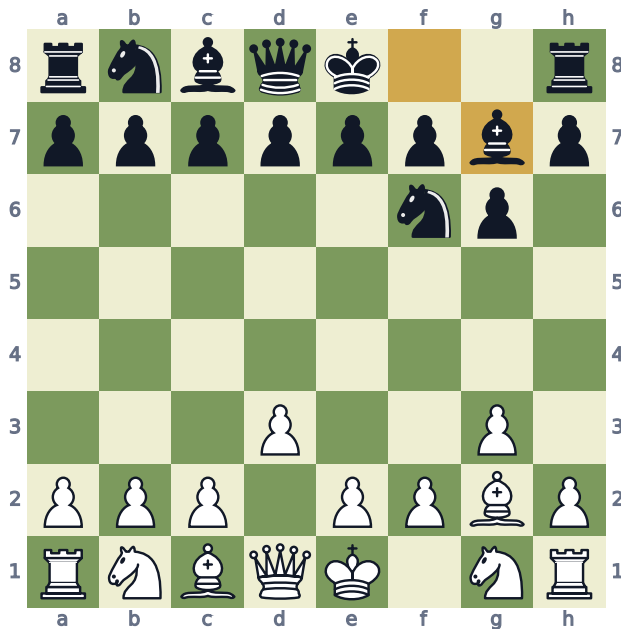
Give the king luft and stop Ng4 before preparing e4 or f4.

MAIN DANGER

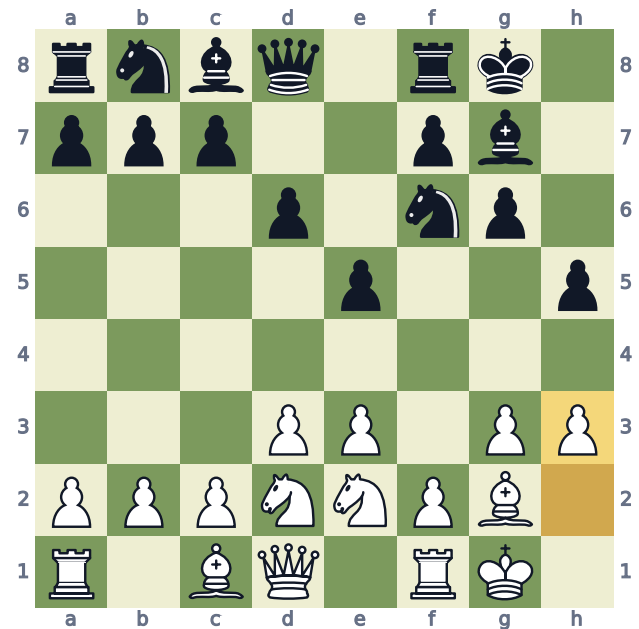
h4 can still gain space and provoke weaknesses.

BRANCH LOGIC 13

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

h3 is useful when it removes a real piece jump.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

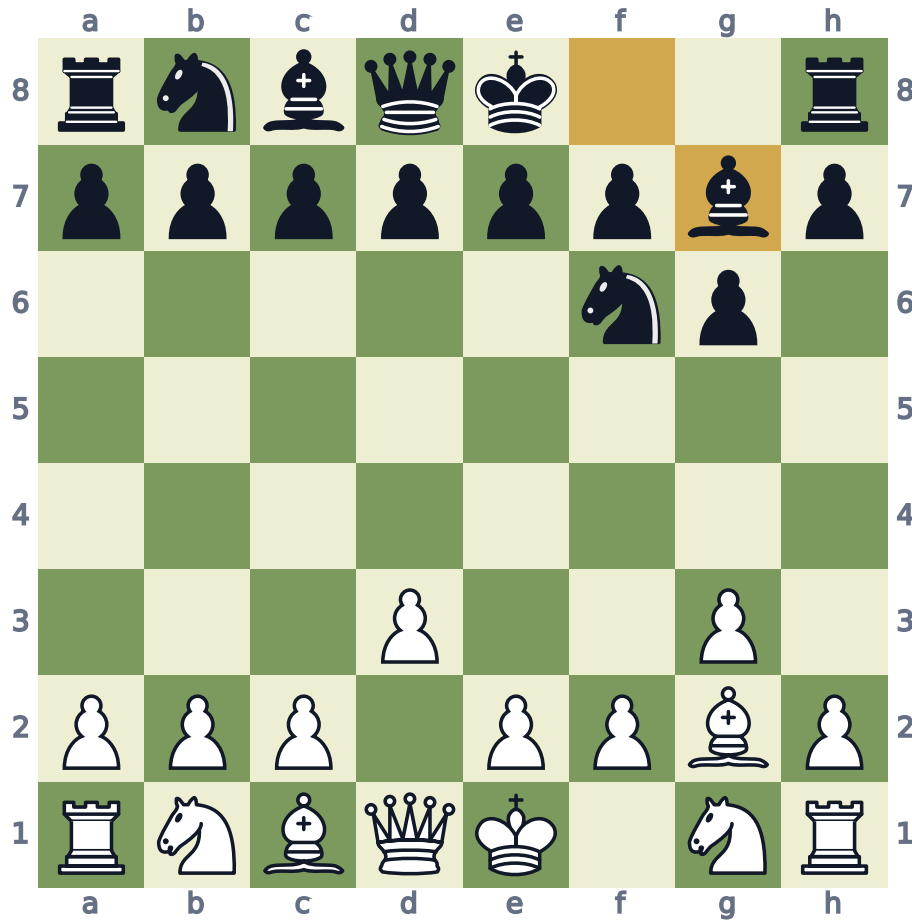
Position estimate: -0.06 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. d5 e4 2. Nc6 exd5 3. Nxd5 Ne4 4. Nde7 Re1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 13

Prophylaxis with h3



YOUR TASK

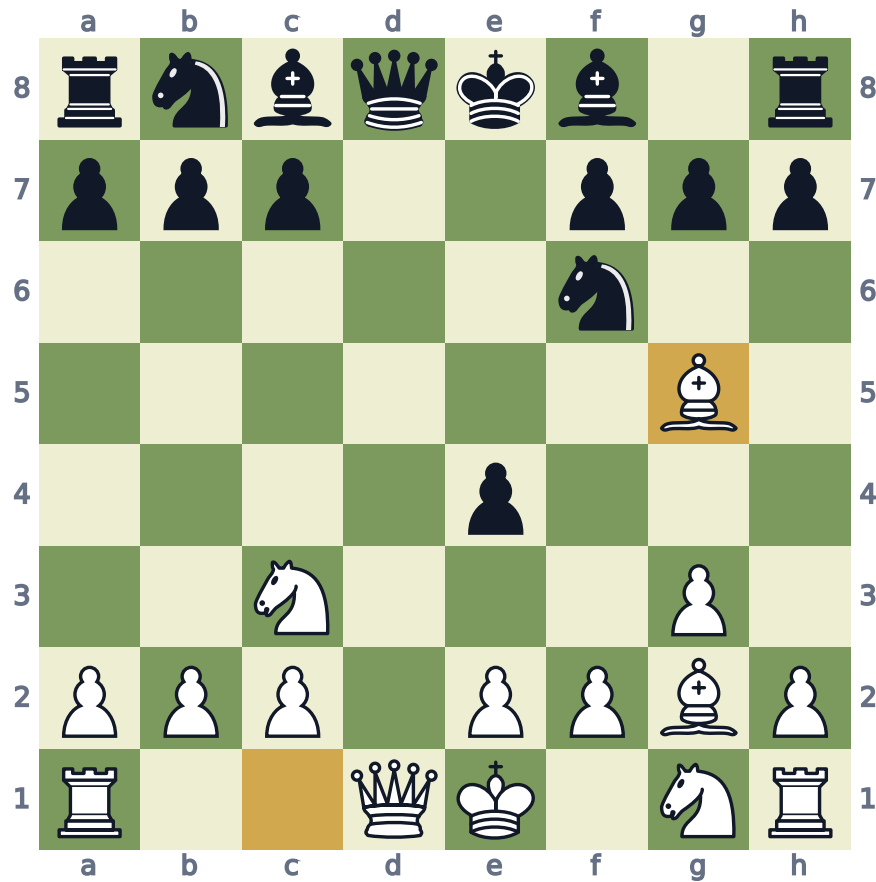
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 14

Emergency defense against e4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 e4 4. dxe4 dxe4 5. Nc3 Nf6 6. Bg5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

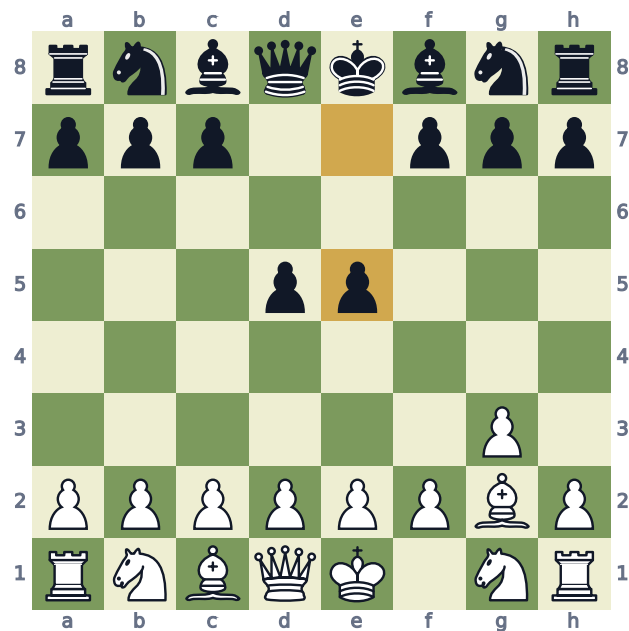
Develop with tempo and pressure the advanced pawn after resolving the center.

MAIN DANGER

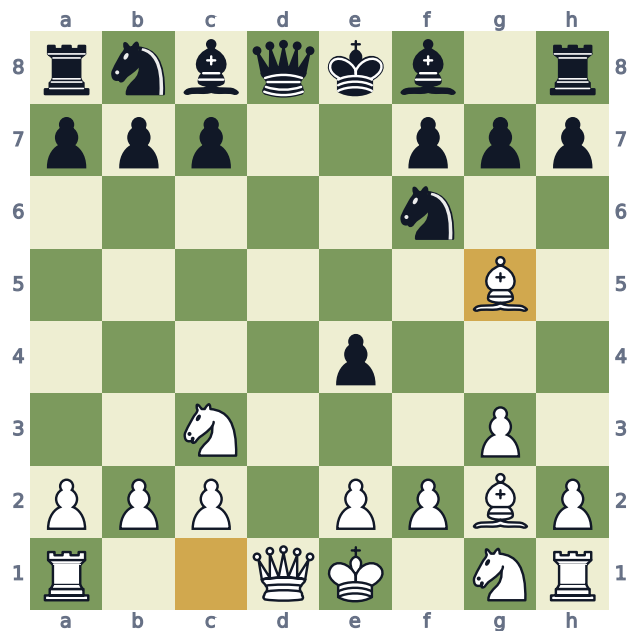
Qxd1+ tactics can appear if the d-file opens.

BRANCH LOGIC 14

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Checks and captures replace the setup checklist when the center advances.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

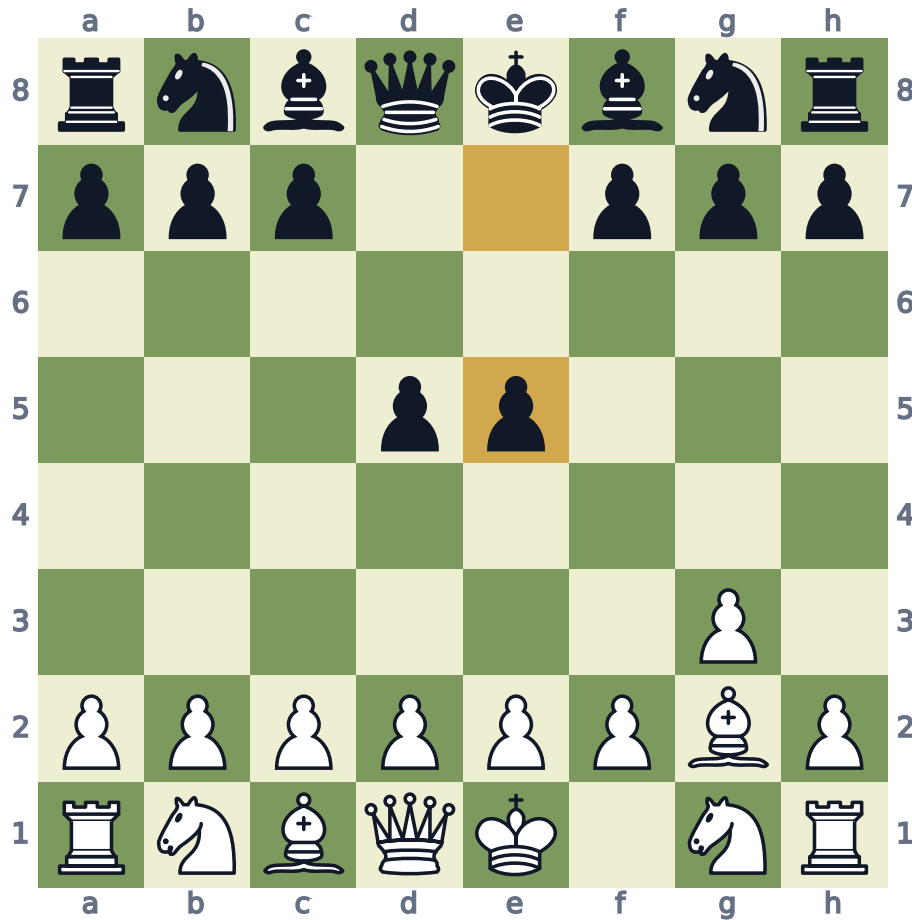
Position estimate: +1.17 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qxd1+ Rxd1 2. Bb4 Bxf6 3. gxf6 Bxe4 4. Nd7 Rd4 5. Bxc3+ bxc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 14

Emergency defense against e4



YOUR TASK

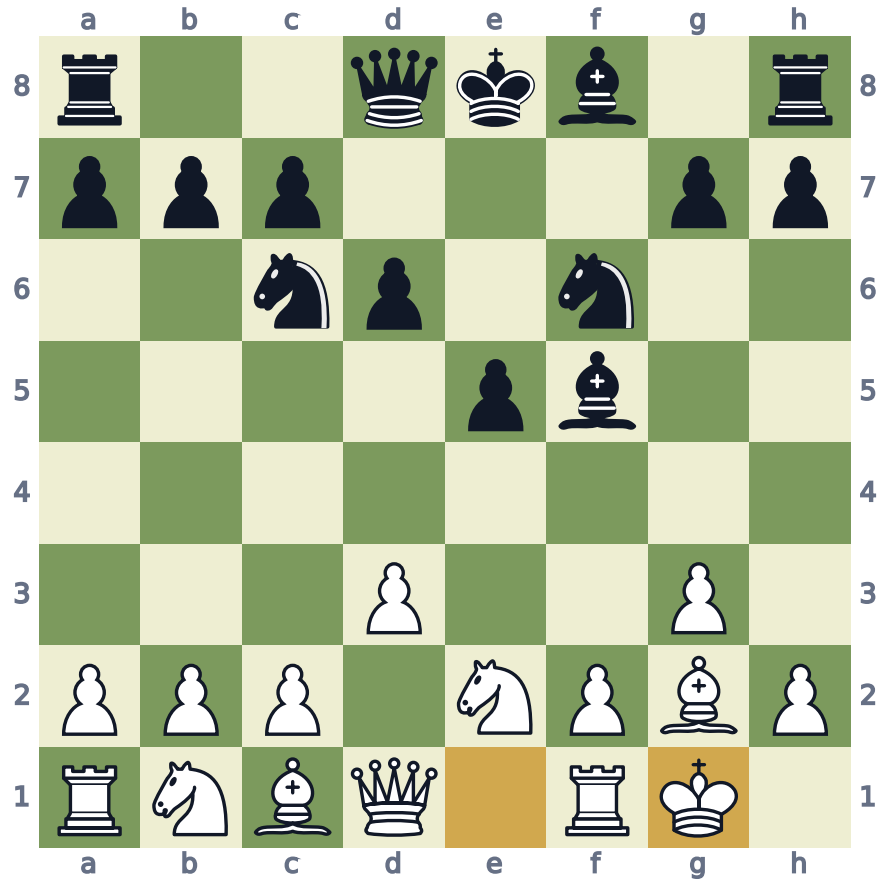
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 15

Emergency defense against f5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 f5 3. d3 Nf6 4. e4 d6 5. exf5 Bxf5 6. Ne2 Nc6 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Return attention to king safety and development after clarifying the f-file.

MAIN DANGER

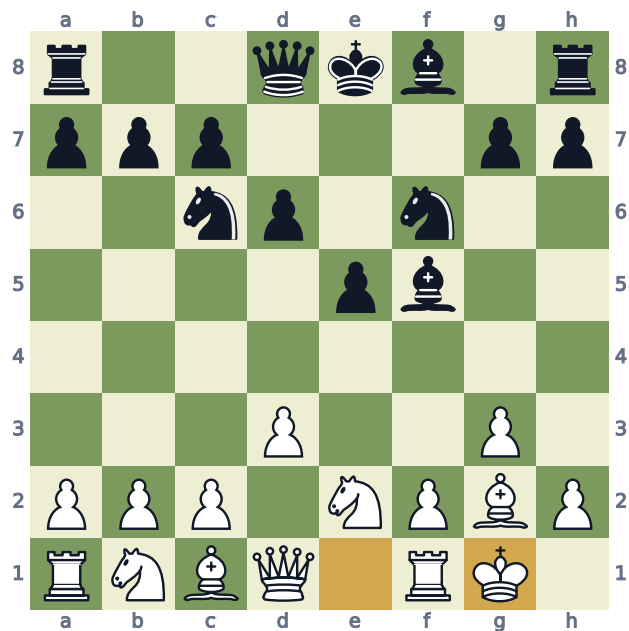
d5 can strike before White completes development.

BRANCH LOGIC 15

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Black attacks early, neutralize the forcing idea and then resume the plan.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

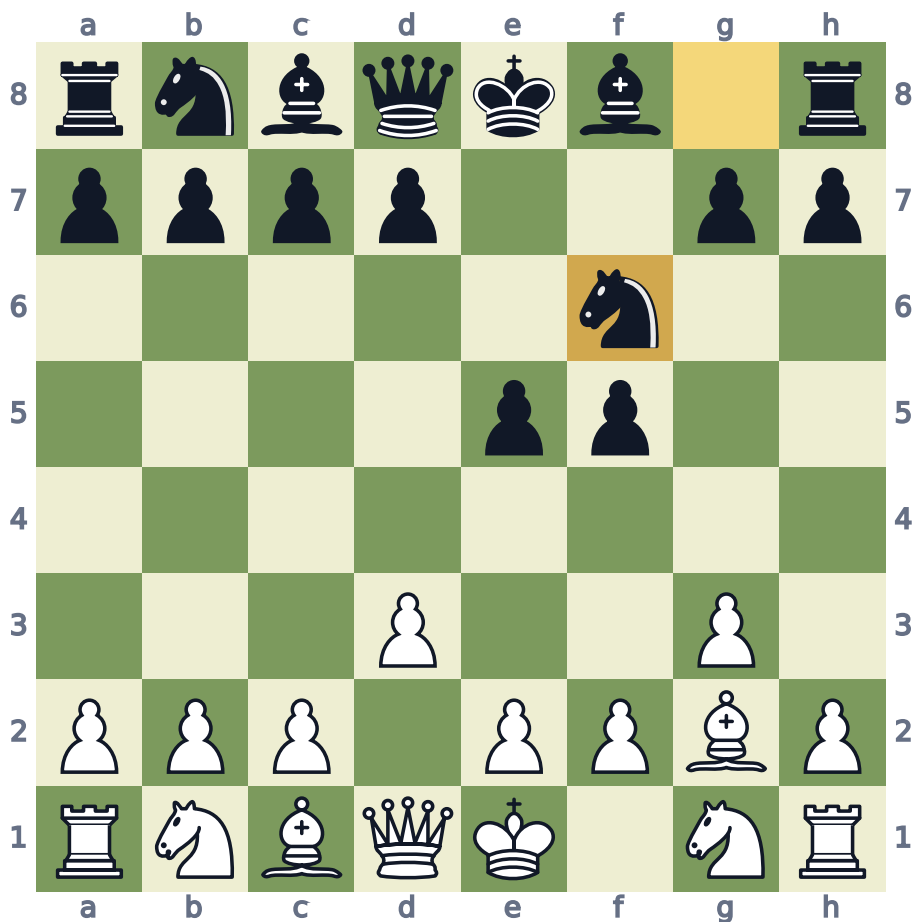
Position estimate: -0.37 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qd7 Bg5 2. Bh3 d4 3. Bxg2 Kxg2 4. Be7 d5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 15

Emergency defense against f5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. ND2 TO F3

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Reroute the d2 knight to f3 when e5 and d4 need more control. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can attack the knight and gain space.

02. ND2 TO C4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use b3 as a route toward c5 and d4 after the center closes. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Bd6 2. O-O O-O 3. c4 c6 4. cxd5 cxd5 5. Bg5 Be6 (-0.23 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: b5 can chase the knight and gain queenside space.

03. NE2 TO C3

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Develop toward d5 and e4 when the f-pawn is no longer the main plan. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can chase the knight or restrict it.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. NE2 TO F4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Aim at e6 and d5 while Black has no e5 pawn that can capture the knight. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: g5 or e5 can challenge the knight later.

05. BB2 AFTER SAFE PREPARATION

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Activate the queen bishop only after c3 closes the a1 diagonal. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c5 2. e3 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. Nge2 Rb8 5. Rb1 O-O (+0.24 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d5 can close the bishop's line immediately.

06. BISHOP STAYS ON C1

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Delay b3 and Bb2 while the center may open and the bishop can use d2 or g5. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can restrict the bishop if it remains undeveloped too long.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-9

07. QUEEN BEHIND E4

Course move: e3. Purpose: Use Qd2 to connect rooks and support e4 after the knight clears the file. Engine comparison: 1. Ngf3 Nc6 2. O-O a5 3. c3 a4 4. Qc2 O-O 5. e4 d4 (-0.38 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can attack the queen's future route and close Bb2.

08. QUEEN BEHIND F4

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Support f4 and keep d1 free for a rook. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: exf4 can open the e-file against the queen.

09. ROOK BEHIND THE E-PAWN

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare e4 with the rook already supporting the file likely to open. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: d5 can close the center and make the rook passive.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 10-12

10. ROOK BEHIND THE F-PAWN

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Keep the f-rook ready for f4 while the queenside rook supports b4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: b5 can make the rook a tactical target.

11. CASTLE BEFORE OPENING THE CENTER

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Secure the king before e4, c4, or d4 opens files. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can gain space during the castling tempo.

12. PROPHYLAXIS WITH A3

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prevent Bb4 ideas and prepare b4 only if the center stays stable. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can make a3 look slow.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 13-15

13. PROPHYLAXIS WITH H3

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Give the king luft and stop Ng4 before preparing e4 or f4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 (+0.10 for White (equal)). Warning: h4 can still gain space and provoke weaknesses.

14. EMERGENCY DEFENSE AGAINST E4

Course move: d3. Purpose: Develop with tempo and pressure the advanced pawn after resolving the center. Engine comparison: 1. d4 exd4 2. Nf3 Bb4+ 3. Nbd2 Be7 4. Nxd4 c5 5. Nb5 Nf6 (-0.18 for White (equal)). Warning: Qxd1+ tactics can appear if the d-file opens.

15. EMERGENCY DEFENSE AGAINST F5

Course move: e4. Purpose: Return attention to king safety and development after clarifying the f-file. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Nc6 2. O-O d5 3. c4 d4 4. e3 dxe3 5. Bxe3 Be7 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d5 can strike before White completes development.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.